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Charging the soul: Tailoring five experiential marketing dimensions to harness the appeal of electric vehicles for different psychological traits

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ABSTRACT

In this paper, we employ actor–network theory to investigate the moderating effect of consumer extroversion and introversion on the relationship between experiential marketing dimensions (sense, feel, think, act and relate) and green purchase intentions in the electric vehicle (EV) market. Drawing on service-dominant logic, we further examine the mediating role of experiential value in this relationship. To test our hypotheses, we collected questionnaire data from 510 respondents in China and analyzed them using partial least squares structural equation modeling. The results show that the five experiential marketing dimensions positively influence both experiential value and green purchase intentions, and experiential value mediates the relationship between the five dimensions and green purchase intentions. They also demonstrate the moderating effects of extroversion and introversion in the relationship between experiential marketing dimensions and experiential value. Specifically, extroversion enhances the moderating effects of the sense, act, and relate dimensions, while introversion enhances the moderating effect of the feel dimension. No significant moderating effect was found for the think dimension. This study advances traditional experiential marketing strategies for eco-friendly intention in the EV sector by introducing a novel integrated model based on actor-network theory and service-dominant logic. By incorporating consumer personality traits as a moderating factor, our model could transform EV marketing from broad, complex campaigns to highly targeted strategies based on consumer segmentation, facilitating more precise and effective allocation of marketing resources.

1. Introduction

Global sales of electric vehicles (EVs) were estimated to reach 14 million units by the end of 2023, with China, the world's largest consumer market for EVs, accounting for more than 50 % of sales (Alsauskas et al., 2023). The homogenized marketing environment and overcapacity in the EV market have led to increasingly fierce pricing competition (Ramos & Ruiz-Gálvez, 2024). EV promotions tend to focus primarily on the technological performance and functionality of EVs rather than their environmental benefits (Guo & Chan, 2015). However, environmental considerations play a significant role in the purchase intentions of millennials (Arora & Singh, 2024; Chaudhary & Kate, 2023). In contrast to general purchase intentions, green purchase intentions reflect consumers' considerations of a product's environmental benefits, such as a reduction in carbon emissions or improved energy efficiency (Amin & Tarun, 2021; Joshi et al., 2021). Promoting green purchase intentions is essential to not only drive sales but also foster sustainable consumption practices to meet broader environmental goals (Almansour, 2022; J. Zhang, Chen, & Li, 2024).

To effectively harness this potential, it is crucial to understand consumer segmentation in the EV market. Current segmentation strategies focus primarily on sociodemographic and economic factors, desired benefits, and behavioral characteristics (Jaiswal et al., 2022), limiting effective engagement and companies' capacity to develop personalized narratives (Tran et al., 2020). Marketing effectiveness may be improved by acknowledging the diversity of consumer motivations, including their cognitive and emotional connections to sustainability (Shanahan et al., 2019). With ongoing advances in technology and increasing awareness of sustainability, it is imperative that EV companies transcend conventional marketing strategies. Exploring consumer

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personality traits such as introversion and extroversion presents an opportunity to enhance the experiential dimensions that promote green purchase intentions.

Experiential marketing has gained significant traction in recent years and is characterized by five dimensions: sensing, feeling, thinking, acting, and relating. Experiential marketing has the potential to increase customers' purchase intentions, satisfaction, engagement, and loyalty (Anggie & Haryanto, 2011; Khan & Rahman, 2014; Rasool et al., 2023; Schmitt, 1999; Yuan & Wu, 2008). As demonstrated by its success in the travel industry, experiential marketing has the potential to boost green purchase intentions of EVs by not only conveying the product's value but also providing a broader green experience through immersive interactions (Shen et al., 2024). For example, interactive displays may be used to demonstrate the low emissions of EVs, while events such as test drives and green community initiatives can create a sense of belonging among eco-conscious consumers.

Experiential marketing of EVs offers a promising avenue for research. Previous research has focused on how technological features and pricing influence general purchase intentions of EVs but has neglected the potential role of experiential marketing in driving green purchasing behaviors (Adu-Gyamfi et al., 2024; Cabeza-Ramírez et al., 2025; Huang & Ge, 2019). While some studies mention aspects of experiential marketing (e.g., multisensory experiences or the integration of the five dimensions into green consumption), they lack insight into the mechanisms by which these dimensions can be combined with personal attributes in the EV industry (Ghali et al., 2024; Laukkanen et al., 2022; Shen et al., 2024; Weber et al., 2021). Moreover, although research findings highlight the importance of personality traits in shaping green consumption intentions (Hamburger et al., 2022; Hirsh, 2014; Milfont & Sibley, 2012) and consumer behaviors (Islam et al., 2017), studies on the relationship between personality traits and the preference for specific experiential marketing dimensions remain scarce. To fill this research gap, the present study examines how experiential marketing influences green purchase intentions via personality traits in the context of EVs, making innovative and theoretical contributions.

We propose an innovative framework that integrates experiential marketing and green purchase intentions in the EV market. By examining the moderating role of consumer personality traits, specifically extroversion and introversion, we seek to clarify the relationship between experiential marketing stimuli and green purchase intentions. Further, we incorporate actor–network theory (ANT) and service-dominant logic (SDL) to uncover the intricate interactions between experiential marketing dimensions and consumer attributes. Ultimately, this research fills an existing gap in the literature and provides actionable insights for EV companies to boost green purchase intentions and achieve a sustainable competitive advantage.

2. Theoretical framework

We build on the strategic experiential marketing framework proposed by Shen et al. (2024) by integrating ANT and SDL, and applying it to the EV market. Our model encompasses the five experiential marketing dimensions, consumer extroversion/introversion, experiential value, and green purchase intentions. This study expands on the existing research, which relies primarily on stimulus–organism–response (S-O-R) theory and experiential marketing strategies (Luo et al., 2011; Prasad et al., 2022; Shen et al., 2024), by accounting for the dynamic interactions between various factors to provide a more comprehensive explanation of consumer behavior.

2.1. Experiential marketing and experiential value

Experiential marketing is aimed at engaging consumers through the use of immersive and sensory-rich elements that evoke positive emotional and cognitive responses and behaviors (Ferreira et al., 2019; Islam et al., 2017; Rasool et al., 2023). In an era of rapid technological advancements (e.g. virtual/augmented reality and artificial intelligence), experiential marketing can significantly enhance brand management and customer experience, far surpassing traditional transaction-based marketing models (Lin & Huang, 2024). Experiential marketing, as defined by Schmitt (1999), is a process through which consumers engage with brand stimuli to build awareness and drive purchases. Over time, it has evolved to emphasize emotional and sensory engagement rather than mere functionality, thereby enhancing brand value (Shahid et al., 2022). Schmitt's (1999) five strategic experiential modules—sense, feel, think, act, and relate—provide a framework for marketing strategies that prioritize customer experience and foster brand loyalty (Rather & Hollebeek, 2021). Experiential value, which is derived from these dimensions, includes both functional and emotional aspects. In the context of EVs, functional value relates to the practical benefits of EVs such as extended driving range and advanced safety features, while emotional value includes the pride and satisfaction associated with driving an eco-friendly vehicle (Adu-Gyamfi et al., 2024; Fu, 2024). Thus, experiential marketing strategies can enhance consumers' purchase intentions (Khan & Rahman, 2014). While experiential marketing has been shown to positively influence customer engagement and loyalty across various industries (e.g., Ferreira et al., 2019; Islam et al., 2017; Rasool et al., 2023), research on how different personality traits interact with the five experiential dimensions, especially in the EV context, remains limited. This study addresses this gap by integrating experiential dimensions with green purchase intentions as consumer behaviors evolve in response to advancing technology and the rise of green markets.

2.2. Actor–network theory (ANT)

ANT posits that any social or technological phenomenon is the result of the dynamic interplay between both human and nonhuman (e.g., technologies, ideas, and policies) actors within a network (Ahn, 2016; Sovacool, 2017). Therefore, the interaction between the various actors in experiential marketing, including consumers, service providers, technological devices, and marketing messages, ultimately shapes consumer behavior and experience. In this study, the five experiential marketing dimensions may be considered the nodes at which human and nonhuman factors interact. For example, the sense dimension involves the sensory stimulation of a product (e.g., the appearance of an EV); the feel and think dimensions involve the affective and cognitive responses, respectively, elicited during the product experience; and the act and relate dimensions involve hands-on experiences and interactions with others (e.g., marketers and consumers) (Centeno & Wang, 2017; da Silveira et al., 2022). ANT argues that these dimensions form a network that enhances the overall consumer experience (Weretecki et al., 2021).

2.3. Service-dominant logic (SDL)

SDL refers to the economic exchange and value co-creation process between service providers and consumers (Tommasetti et al., 2017). It views value creation as a collaborative process between firms and consumers, with value being determined by a consumer's subjective experience of a product, directly influencing their purchase decisions (Ghali et al., 2024; Hollebeek, Srivastava, & Chen, 2019; Rasool et al., 2023). Brakus et al. (2014) found that the functional and emotional value derived from multidimensional experiential marketing enhances consumers' purchase intentions. This reinforces consumers' eco-friendly choices, aligning with the value cocreation perspective in SDL (Ercsey, 2017).

Personality is a key factor shaping consumer behavior and interactions in service settings and influences the value cocreation process (Uslu & Tosun, 2024). For example, extroversion and introversion fundamentally influence how individuals interact with external stimuli and experiences. Extroverts tend to seek out highly stimulating and energizing environments, excitement, and social interactions, while

introverts prefer low-stimulus, low-intensity environments where they can reflect on their internal cognitive experience (H. J. Eysenck, 1990; Hamburger et al., 2022; Moshkovitz & Hayat, 2021; Rather et al., 2022). SDL's cocreation framework allows for such individual differences and supports the idea of personality traits moderating the relationship between experiential marketing and experiential value.

In this study, extroversion and introversion are conceptualized as potential moderators of the relationship between experiential value and its antecedents. Given their clearly opposing nature, extroversion and introversion are relatively simple to measure, making it easier to test their moderating effects. In contrast, the multidimensional Big Five model (openness, conscientiousness, agreeableness, extroversion, and neuroticism) (Mehmetoglu, 2012) is more complex, making it more challenging to identify the moderating effect of each trait. Therefore, focusing solely on extroversion and introversion may provide more actionable insights for companies to tailor their marketing strategies to different consumers and improve their marketing effectiveness. Fig. 1 illustrates the research model.

3. Hypothesis development

3.1. Experiential marketing, experiential value, and purchase intentions of electric vehicles

Schmitt's (1999) experiential marketing framework includes five strategic experiential dimensions—sense, feel, think, act, and relate—which significantly influence customers' purchase intentions (Khan & Rahman, 2014; Schmitt, 1999; Yuan & Wu, 2008). In terms of the sense dimension, Esteky (2021) found that exposing consumers to sensory cues associated with nature promotes eco-friendly consumption decisions, while Laukkanen et al. (2022) demonstrated that interactions between tactile, visual, olfactory, and auditory senses can result in environmentally friendly and sustainable decisions. In terms of the feel dimension, research shows that emphasizing a product's eco-friendly features generates positive emotions such as pride and caring when consumers purchase the product (J. S. Hwang et al., 2023; Ragbir et al., 2021; X. Zhang, Chen, & Li, 2024). The think dimension relates to consumers' cognitive responses to marketing, influencing their brand evaluations and pro-environmental intentions (Hartmann et al., 2005, 2014). The act dimension focuses on hands-on experiences such as product trials, demonstrations, workshops, and interactive displays, enabling consumers to physically interact with a brand or product (An et al., 2022; Rather, 2020). This shifts the customer experience from passively receiving information about a product to actively exploring it (e.g., customizing an EV or visualizing the charging network), potentially boosting their purchase intentions (Khan & Rahman, 2014; S. Y. Lee et al., 2021). Having practical and short-term experience with EVs can change consumers' evaluations of them and the psychological factors that determine their behavioral intentions (Schmalfuβ et al., 2017). Within the relate dimension, building social connections reinforces shared green values, fosters collective identity, and ultimately increases individuals' green purchase intentions (J. S. Hwang et al., 2023; C. K. C. Lee et al., 2015). Therefore, we propose the following hypotheses.

H1a. The sense dimension of experiential marketing positively influences green purchase intentions in the EV market.

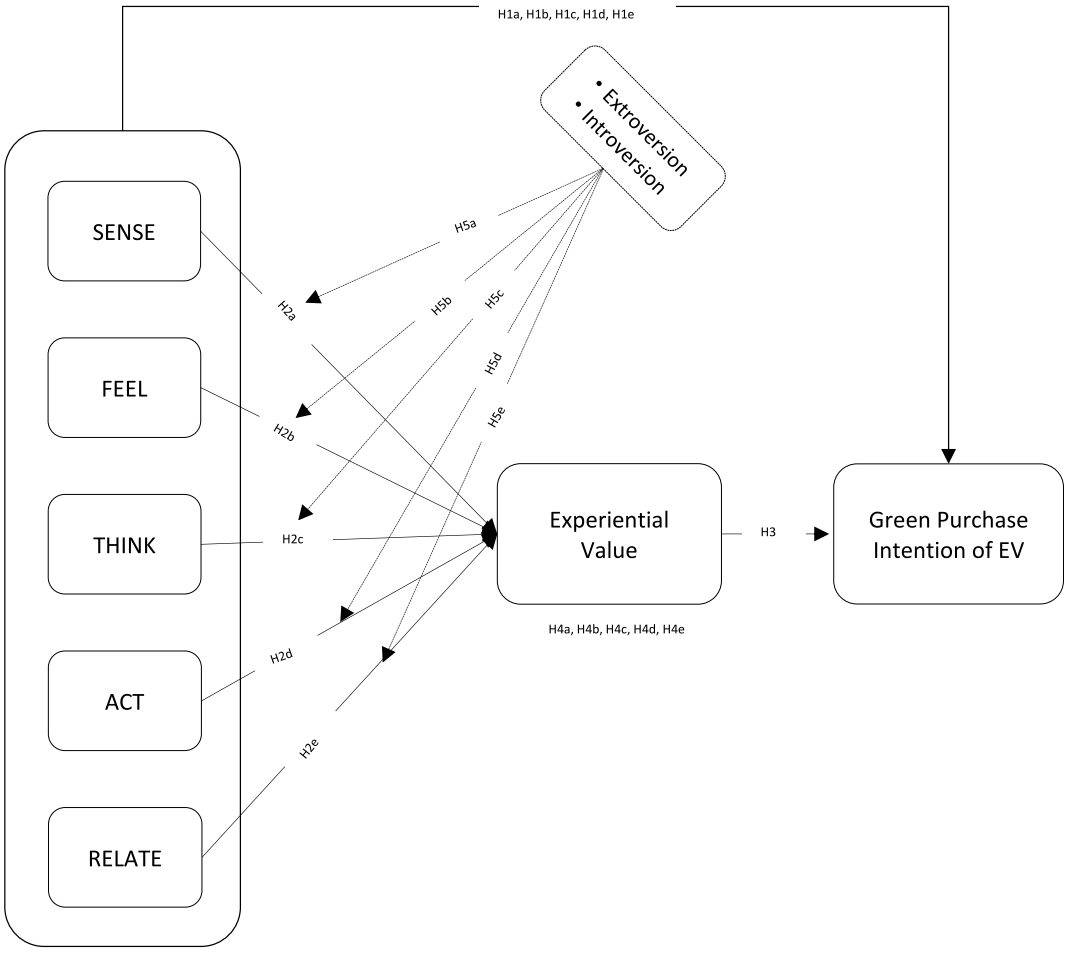


Fig. 1. Conceptual framework.

H1b. The feel dimension of experiential marketing positively influences green purchase intentions in the EV market.

H1c. The think dimension of experiential marketing positively influences green purchase intentions in the EV market.

H1d. The act dimension of experiential marketing positively influences green purchase intentions in the EV market.

H1e. The relate dimension of experiential marketing positively influences green purchase intentions in the EV market.

Experiential value, which includes functional and emotional value, derives from the five key experiential marketing dimensions (Schmitt, 1999; Yuan & Wu, 2008). The functional value of EVs includes practical benefits such as extended driving range and advanced safety features, enhancing the driving experience (Adu-Gyamfi et al., 2024; Fu, 2024). Emotional value refers to consumers' feelings during and after engaging with a product, such as pride from driving an eco-friendly vehicle or enjoyment from a smooth driving experience (Berry et al., 2002; He et al., 2023). The sense dimension involves visual, auditory, and tactile stimuli to enhance consumers' perception of product quality (Yoganathan et al., 2019). A pleasurable sensory experience increases the overall experiential value for consumers (Wiedmann et al., 2018). The feel dimension is designed to elicit strong emotions and empathy from consumers (Naser Alsaid & Ben Amor, 2020; Schmitt, 1999; Yuan & Wu, 2008), enabling customers to emotionally connect with a brand (Williams, 2006). Events and activities that elicit positive emotions enhance the perceived value of a product (Naser Alsaid & Ben Amor, 2020). The think dimension stimulates creative thinking by encouraging new ideas or reflections on a company or its product. Cognitive engagement through surprise, intrigue, and provocation can increase consumers' perceived value of a product (Naser Alsaid & Ben Amor, 2020; Schmitt, 1999). The act dimension proposes new ways of doing things and alternative lifestyles and interactions (Schmitt, 1999), increasing consumers' trust in and preference for the product (Khan & Rahman, 2014; S. Y. Lee et al., 2021). The relate dimension fosters sociocultural associations between consumers and brands (Yu & Ko, 2012), enhancing value. Collectively, these five dimensions enhance experiential value (Naser Alsaid & Ben Amor, 2020). In the EV sector, marketing activities such as test drives, demonstrations, enthusiast events, and green campaigns that reflect these five dimensions will contribute to experiential value. Therefore, we propose the following hypotheses.

H2a. The sense dimension of experiential marketing positively influences consumers' perceived experiential value.

H2b. The feel dimension of experiential marketing positively influences consumers' perceived experiential value.

H2c. The think dimension of experiential marketing positively influences consumers' perceived experiential value.

H2d. The act dimension of experiential marketing positively influences consumers' perceived experiential value.

H2e. The relate dimension of experiential marketing positively influences consumers' perceived experiential value.

3.2. Mediating role of experiential value

Studies have revealed a strong association between experiential value and purchase intentions, particularly when environmental factors are present (Roemer & Henseler, 2022; Zefreh et al., 2023). Interacting with eco-friendly products enhances consumer trust and perceived functional and emotional value, boosting purchase intentions (Wu et al., 2018). Moreover, previous studies have found that experiential value mediates the relationships between customer engagement and repatronage intentions (S.-H. Liao et al., 2024), between experiential marketing and online store revisit intentions (Overmars & Poels, 2015), and between interactive music and purchase intentions (A. H. Hwang et al., 2020). Additionally, drawing on SDL, which focuses on value cocreation between service providers and consumers (Tommasetti et al., 2017), we posit that experiential value mediates the relationship between experiential marketing dimensions and green purchase intentions.

H3. Experiential value positively influences consumers' green purchase intentions of EVs.

H4a. Experiential value mediates the positive relationship between the sense dimension of experiential marketing and purchase intentions of EVs.

H4b. Experiential value mediates the positive relationship between the feel dimension of experiential marketing and purchase intentions of EVs.

H4c. Experiential value mediates the positive relationship between the think dimension of experiential marketing and purchase intentions of EVs.

H4d. Experiential value mediates the positive relationship between the act dimension of experiential marketing and purchase intentions of EVs.

H4e. Experiential value mediates the positive relationship between the relate dimension of experiential marketing and purchase intentions of EVs.

3.3. Moderating role of extroversion and introversion

According to ANT, experiential value is cocreated through the dynamic interactions of human and nonhuman actors within a network (Ahn, 2016; Sovacool, 2017). The interaction between consumers (as human actors) and experiential marketing dimensions (as nonhuman actors) varies according to the personality traits of the human actors, informing the cocreation of experiential value (Weretecki et al., 2021). However, existing experiential marketing frameworks overlook the moderating effects of personality traits (Luo et al., 2011; Prasad et al., 2022; Shen et al., 2024). Personality traits are included in this study because they reflect an individual's values, motivations, and preferences and are generally stable over time (Itani et al., 2020). Specifically, extroversion and introversion, which exist on a continuum, are enduring personality traits that significantly influence customers' attitudes and behaviors (Hamburger et al., 2022; Viswanathan et al., 2018). Marketers can segment customers according to these traits and tailor their communication strategies to appeal to either extroverts or introverts (Hamburger et al., 2022).

Extroversion and introversion are core personality traits linked to biological processes, specifically cortical arousal levels (H. J. Eysenck, 1990). Introverts have a higher baseline arousal and seek less stimulation, while extroverts have a lower baseline arousal and seek more stimulation. Extroverts are sociable, energetic, and gain satisfaction from social interactions, whereas introverts are more reserved, enjoy solitude, and prefer fewer and deeper interactions (C.-M. Chang et al., 2023; Itani et al., 2020; Song et al., 2023). According to H. J. Eysenck's (1990) theory of personality, extroverts are more sensitive to external stimuli and novel experiences, whereas introverts demonstrate lower sensitivity to such stimuli. Therefore, in EV marketing, sensory stimuli such as vibrant interior lighting, immersive music effects, or sensory stimulation are more likely to elicit positive evaluations from extroverts (Moshkovitz & Hayat, 2021). Conversely, introverts are less driven by sensory stimulation and require more thoughtful strategies to make purchasing decisions (Moshkovitz & Hayat, 2021). Thus, we hypothesize.

H5a. Extroversion and introversion moderate the relationship

between the sense dimension and experiential value, with extroverts experiencing a stronger moderating effect compared with introverts.

Emotional experiences are critical in consumer decision-making (Zeithaml, 1988). Compared with extroverts, introverts typically have more complex and deeper self-perceptions and emotional experiences (Jung, 1971) and are more aroused by emotional stimuli (Smith et al., 1995). While some studies suggest that extroverts are more likely to be influenced by shallow emotional experiences, the emotional marketing of EVs includes not only shallow emotional pleasure but also pride in green consumption, aligning with personal values (Chaturvedi et al., 2022; Dennis et al., 2022). These represent deep and multilayered emotional experiences. Given their introspective nature and the richness and depth of their emotional experiences, introverts are more likely to perceive and internalize these deep and complex emotional experiences (Thi & Duong, 2025). In contrast, extroverts' emotional experiences are more superficial and diffuse, and they may not reflect on their experiences as deeply (Smith et al., 1995). Therefore, we propose that introverts are more likely than extroverts to perceive deep and complex emotional experiences.

H5b. Extroversion and introversion moderate the relationship between the feel dimension and experiential value, with introverts experiencing a stronger moderating effect compared with extroverts.

According to Cattell's theory of intelligence, introverts exhibit higher levels of crystallized intelligence, enabling them to analyze complex problems more deeply (Djapo et al., 2011). This trait manifests in the think dimension, where introverts are more motivated to research and understand the technical details and long-term benefits of EVs (Djapo et al., 2011). Extroverts, in contrast, may rely more on fluid intelligence and focus on immediate perceptions and first impressions rather than technical specifications (Brown, 2016). Workshops led by engineers or experts, where attendees learn about EV advancements and environmental benefits, are particularly engaging for introverts. They appreciate the opportunity to dive deeply into technical details, ask questions, and absorb information at their own pace, in line with their crystallized intelligence (Djapo et al., 2011; Moshkovitz & Hayat, 2021). In contrast, extroverts focus more on the social and sensory aspects of the event, seeking quick, surface-level engagement and forming impressions based on overall excitement rather than detailed knowledge (Brown, 2016). Therefore, we hypothesize.

H5c. Extroversion and introversion moderate the relationship between the think dimension and experiential value, with introverts experiencing a stronger moderating effect compared with extroverts.

Extroverts are generally exploratory and adventurous, often seeking external stimuli and engaging in high levels of activity (H. J. Eysenck, 1990). When choosing EVs, extroverts may show a strong interest in experiential activities such as test drives to satisfy their curiosity and enhance their connection to the product. They enjoy sharing information and feedback with the public, with whom they feel comfortable expressing their emotions and sharing their personal experiences (Itani et al., 2020). Therefore, they engage in actions such as taking selfies and posting in social media to share their experiences (Dinesh & Mitra, 2023; Itani et al., 2020; Kim & Chock, 2017). In contrast, introverts tend to approach new technologies with caution, requiring additional time to process information and assess the risks rather than sharing their perceptions on social media before acting (Hamburger et al., 2022). Therefore, we hypothesize.

H5d. Extroversion and introversion moderate the relationship between the act dimension and experiential value, with extroverts experiencing a stronger moderating effect compared with introverts.

Extroverts derive great pleasure from sharing information and fostering social relationships, preferring active involvement in social activities. They seek attention, develop relationships, and gain happiness through socializing. In contrast, introverts are less motivated by social status and relationships, finding satisfaction in more introspective and solitary pursuits (Itani et al., 2020; Viswanathan et al., 2018). Extroverts may be more inclined to participate in community activities related to EVs and build connections with other enthusiasts (Mai & Olsen, 2015). Conversely, introverts focus more on how EVs align with their personal values (Jiao et al., 2018). Thus, we hypothesize.

H5e. Extroversion and introversion moderate the relationship between the relate dimension and experiential value, with extroverts experiencing a stronger moderating effect compared with introverts.

4. Methodology

4.1. Sample

We used Wenjuanxing.com, a well-known Chinese market research platform similar to Amazon Mechanical Turk, to conduct an online survey in July 2024. The platform randomly distributes questionnaires to its vast user base of over 30 million people to select a target group of respondents. It includes several robust procedures to safeguard against cheating, including cross-referencing responses to related questions, assessing answer times, verifying IP addresses, posing lie detector questions, and preventing the same user from earning prizes for completing surveys more than once. Therefore, the likelihood of repetitive or thoughtless responses was significantly reduced, improving the accuracy of collected data.

The intended audience for this study was prospective or current EV customers who were familiar with advertising campaigns for new-generation EVs. We selected China because it is the world's largest market for EVs, it has a robust growth potential and substantial policy support, and it has made rapid advances in technological innovations, environmental sustainability, and e-commerce development (Huang & Ge, 2019). Respondents received a reward of 3–5 RMB for completing the survey.

The survey yielded 510 valid replies. Participant age ranged from 20 to 59 years, with an average age of 34.7 years. Of the 510 respondents, 65.1 % (n = 332) were male, and 79 % (n = 403) held at least a bachelor's degree. In a three-wave longitudinal survey, Qian et al. (2023) reported that 74.75 % of electric vehicle consumers hold a bachelor's degree or higher, and that Generation Y comprises most of the sample. Likewise, Y. Liao (2022) found that 72.6 % of respondents with EV purchase intentions held a bachelor's degree or higher. Similarly, a recent study by Xingjun et al. (2024) further confirms that highly educated individuals account for 74.33 % of the EV consumer group. These findings collectively indicate that the demographic characteristics of our sample align with those of the Chinese EV-using population. Table 1 presents respondents' demographic information.

4.2. Measurements

We adapted measures from previous research to fit the EV context. We measured experiential marketing using 16 items adapted from Naser Alsaid and Ben Amor (2020), with the sense dimension comprising three items, the feel dimension comprising four items, the think dimension comprising three items, the act dimension comprising two items, and the relate dimension comprising four items. We measured experiential value using six items adapted from Shen et al. (2024). We measured purchase intentions for EVs using 10 items adapted from Ali et al. (2020). All scales were based on a seven-point Likert scale ranging from 1 (*strongly disagree*) to 7 (*strongly agree*). We used six yes or no questions from the abbreviated revised Eysenck Personality Questionnaire (Francis et al., 1992) to assess extroversion/introversion. Participants who scored between 4 and 6 were categorized as extroverts, while those scoring between 1 and 3 were classified as introverts.

Table 1
Respondents' demographic information.

Demographic	Category	No of Resp.	Percentage (%)
Gender	Male	332	65.1
	Female	178	34.9
Marital status	Single	311	61.0
	Married	199	39.0
Age	<20	0	0.0
	20–29	154	30.2
	30–39	235	46.1
	40–49	78	15.3
	50–59	43	8.4
	>60	0	0.0
Education	below Diploma	13	2.5
	Diploma	94	18.4
	Bachelor	141	27.6
	Master	213	41.8
	PhD	49	9.6
Income	<2000	14	2.7
	2001–3000	31	6.1
	3001–4000	70	13.7
	4001–5000	93	18.2
	5001–6000	193	37.8
	>6000	109	21.4

5. Analysis and results

5.1. Common-method variance

We employed two statistical approaches to assess common-method variance to ensure the validity of our findings (S.-J. Chang et al., 2010). First, we used Kock's (2015) full collinearity test to estimate the model's variance inflation factors, all of which were below the 3.5 cutoff, with values ranging from 1.0 to 3.5. Next, we used the measured latent marker variable technique, as suggested by Miller and Simmering (2023). Ideally, the marker variable should differ theoretically from the variables being examined. We found that the R^2 values for experiential value and green purchase intentions were almost identical in the regression model with and without the marker variable. Based on these findings, we determined that common-method variance was not a significant problem.

5.2. Reliability and validity

We evaluated the reliability of the constructs using SmartPLS 4 with 5000 bootstrap samples. To assess convergent validity, we applied Fornell and Larcker's (1981) criteria: (i) standardized factor loadings >0.50, (ii) composite reliability >0.70, and (iii) average variance extracted (AVE) > 0.50. All Cronbach's alpha values surpassed the recommended threshold of 0.70. The composite reliability of all constructs ranged from 0.881 to 0.954, exceeding the threshold of 0.70 and AVE values ranged from 0.643 to 0.873. These results confirm a high level of convergent validity (see Table 2).

According to Fornell and Larcker (1981), discriminant validity is considered high if the square root of the AVE for each latent variable is greater than the absolute value of the correlation coefficients between the latent variables. This indicates that the internal correlations within each latent variable are greater than the external correlations between different latent variables, demonstrating that the latent variables are distinct from each other. Table 3 shows that the square root of AVE in this study ranged from 0.802 to 0.934. The maximum correlation coefficient between variables was 0.629, and the minimum square root of AVE exceeded this maximum correlation coefficient. This confirms that the study met the standards for discriminant validity.

According to Henseler et al. (2015), the heterotrait-monotrait (HTMT) ratio should be less than 0.90 (or ideally 0.85) to show adequate discriminant validity. In this study, all values were below 0.85, further confirming discriminant validity (see Table 4).

Table 2
Test results for reliability and convergent validity for reflective constructs.

Construct	Indicator	Outer loadings	Cronbach's alpha	CR	AVE
SENSE	S1	0.874	0.795	0.880	0.710
	S2	0.789			
	S3	0.862			
FEEL	F1	0.793	0.883	0.920	0.742
	F2	0.877			
	F3	0.902			
	F4	0.869			
THINK	T1	0.937	0.927	0.954	0.873
	T2	0.936			
	T3	0.930			
ACT	A1	0.886	0.765	0.895	0.809
	A2	0.913			
RELATE	R1	0.824	0.828	0.886	0.660
	R2	0.853			
	R3	0.827			
	R4	0.742			
Experiential value	EV1	0.898	0.926	0.942	0.732
	EV2	0.908			
	EV3	0.802			
	EV4	0.776			
	EV5	0.886			
	EV6	0.854			
Green purchase intention of EVs	GPI1	0.842	0.860	0.899	0.643
	GPI2	0.769			
	GPI3	0.766			
	GPI4	0.744			
	GPI5	0.879			

Table 3
Discriminant validity (Fornell-Larcker criterion).

	SENSE	FEEL	THINK	ACT	RELATE	EV	GPI
SENSE	**0.843**						
FEEL	0.436	**0.861**					
THINK	0.361	0.379	**0.934**				
ACT	0.258	0.364	0.256	**0.900**			
RELATE	0.380	0.458	0.193	0.356	**0.812**		
EV	0.505	0.584	0.382	0.414	0.512	**0.856**	
GPI	0.506	0.439	0.369	0.316	0.416	0.629	**0.802**

Note(s): EV refers to Experiential Value; GPI refer to Green Purchase Intention of EV.

Table 4
Discriminant validity (HTMT).

	SENSE	FEEL	THINK	ACT	RELATE	EV	GPI
SENSE							
FEEL	0.517						
THINK	0.423	0.415					
ACT	0.329	0.437	0.298				
RELATE	0.453	0.526	0.208	0.442			
EV	0.579	0.641	0.407	0.490	0.577		
GPI	0.611	0.498	0.413	0.380	0.479	0.691	

Note(s): EV refers to Experiential Value; GPI refer to Green Purchase Intention.

5.3. Structural model

According to Hair et al. (2017), R^2 values of 0.75, 0.50, and 0.25 indicate strong, moderate, and weak explanatory power, respectively. As shown in Table 5, the R^2 of experiential value was 0.491, indicating that the five dimensions (sense, feel, think, act, and relate) explain 49.1 % of the variance in experiential value. The R^2 of green purchase intentions was 0.394, indicating that experiential value explains 39.4 % of the variance in green purchase intentions. Effect size (f^2) reflects the strength of the relationship ($f^2 < 0.020$: no significant effect, $f^2 = 0.020$–0.149: small effect size; $f^2 = 0.150$–0.349: medium effect size; $f^2 > 0.350$: large effect size) (Gefen & Straub, 2005; Kemény et al., 2016).

Table 5
Hypothesis testing.

Effects	Hypothesis and Relationship	Original sample (O)	Sample mean (M)	Standard deviation (STDEV)	T statistics (|O/STDEV|)	Decision
Direct effects	H1a: SENSE - > GPI	0.135	0.136	0.026	5.281***	Supported
	H1b: FEEL - > GPI	0.184	0.185	0.026	7.086***	Supported
	H1c: THINK - > GPI	0.071	0.071	0.023	3.139**	Supported
	H1d: ACT - > GPI	0.090	0.090	0.023	3.847***	Supported
	H1e: RELATE - > GPI	0.140	0.141	0.026	5.469***	Supported
	H2a: SENSE - > EV	0.215	0.216	0.039	5.459***	Supported
	H2b: FEEL - > EV	0.293	0.294	0.040	7.382***	Supported
	H2c: THINK - > EV	0.113	0.113	0.035	3.189**	Rejected
	H2d: ACT - > EV	0.144	0.143	0.037	3.895***	Supported
	H2e: RELATE - > EV	0.223	0.224	0.039	5.762***	Supported
	H3: EV - > GPI	0.629	0.63	0.025	25.402***	Supported
Indirect effects	H4a: SENSE - > EV - > GPI	0.135	0.136	0.026	5.281***	Supported
	H4b: FEEL - > EV - > GPI	0.184	0.185	0.026	7.086***	Supported
	H4c: THINK - > EV - > GPI	0.071	0.071	0.023	3.139**	Supported
	H4d: ACT - > EV - > GPI	0.090	0.090	0.023	3.847***	Supported
	H5e: RELATE - > EV - > GPI	0.14	0.141	0.026	5.469***	Supported
	H6a: PERSONALITY x SENSE - > EV	−0.17	−0.169	0.077	2.194*	Supported
	H6b: PERSONALITY x FEEL - > EV	0.295	0.292	0.081	3.636***	Supported
	H6c: PERSONALITY x THINK - > EV	0.113	0.113	0.069	1.637	Rejected
	H6d: PERSONALITY x ACT - > EV	−0.16	−0.159	0.071	2.238*	Supported
	H6e: PERSONALITY x RELATE - > EV	−0.241	−0.239	0.076	3.159**	Supported

Note(s): EV refers to Experiential Value; GPI refer to Green Purchase Intention; *p < .05; **p < .01; ***p < .001.

In this study, the effects of sense ($f^2 = 0.066$), feel ($f^2 = 0.110$), think ($f^2 = 0.020$), act ($f^2 = 0.033$), and relate ($f^2 = 0.071$) on experiential value were small, while the effect of experiential value on green purchase intentions ($f^2 = 0.654$) was large.

The path analysis revealed significant relationships between several variables. Table 5 shows that all five experiential marketing dimensions significantly affect green purchase intentions and experiential value ($p < .01$). Additionally, experiential value positively affects green purchase intentions ($p < .01$). These results support H1a–e, H2a–e, and H3, indicating that our theoretical model is valid.

The results of our mediation analysis reveal a significant indirect effect of multiple variables on green purchase intentions via experiential value. All five experiential marketing dimensions had a significant indirect effect on green purchase intentions via experiential value. Specifically, the indirect effects of the sense, feel, think, act, and relate dimensions on green purchase intentions via experiential value were 0.135 ($t = 5.281$, $p = .000$), 0.184 (t = 7.086, $p = .000$), 0.071 ($t = 3.139$, $p = .002$), 0.090 ($t = 3.847$, $p = .000$), and 0.140 ($t = 5.469$, $p = .000$), respectively. These results suggest that experiential value mediates the relationship between experiential marketing dimensions and green purchase intentions, supporting H4a–e.

We also examined the moderating role of extroversion and introversion on the relationship between experiential marketing dimensions and experiential value. We found that extroversion/introversion negatively and significantly moderate the effects of the sense dimension ($t = 2.194$, $\beta = -0.17$, $p < .05$), the act dimension ($t = 2.238$, $\beta = -0.16$, $p < .05$), and the relate dimension ($t = 3.159$, $\beta = -0.241$, $p < .01$) on experiential value, supporting H5a, H5d, and H5e. Conversely, extroversion/introversion positively and significantly moderate the effect of the feel dimension on experiential value ($t = 1.637$, $\beta = 0.295$, $p < .001$), supporting H5b. However, the moderating effect of the think dimension on experiential value was nonsignificant ($t = 1.637$, $\beta = 0.113$, $p > .05$), rejecting H5c.

Figs. 2–6 illustrate the moderating effects of extroversion/introversion on the relationships between the five experiential marketing dimensions and experiential value. Figs. 2, 5 and 6 show that the moderating effects of the sense, act, and relate dimensions on experiential value are weaker for introverts and stronger for extroverts. Conversely, Fig. 3 shows that the moderating effect of the feel dimension on experiential value is stronger for introverts and weaker for extroverts.

6. Discussion and conclusion

We developed and tested an integrated model to explore the relationship between the five experiential marketing dimensions and EV purchase intentions, the mediating role of experiential value, and the moderating role of consumer extroversion/introversion. The results indicate that all five dimensions of experiential marketing—sense, feel, think, act, and relate—have a positive influence on both experiential value and EV purchase intentions. These effects vary for introverts and extroverts. Given their introspective nature, introverts tend to focus more on personal growth, self-reflection, and the depth of social interaction, while extroverts are more sensory, action-oriented, and focus on superficial relational aspects (Zelenski et al., 2012). Consequently, the current marketing strategies for EVs may not fully address the needs of introverts. Future research should investigate tailored marketing strategies for this segment.

The data reveal that extroverted and introverted customers differ in

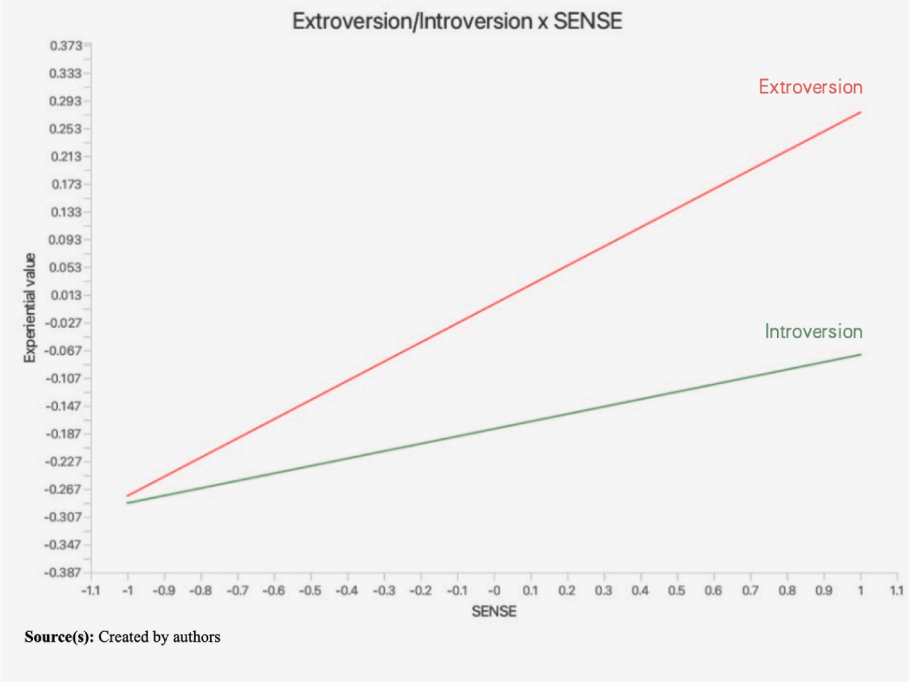


Fig. 2. Interaction diagram of personality between SENSE and Experiential value.

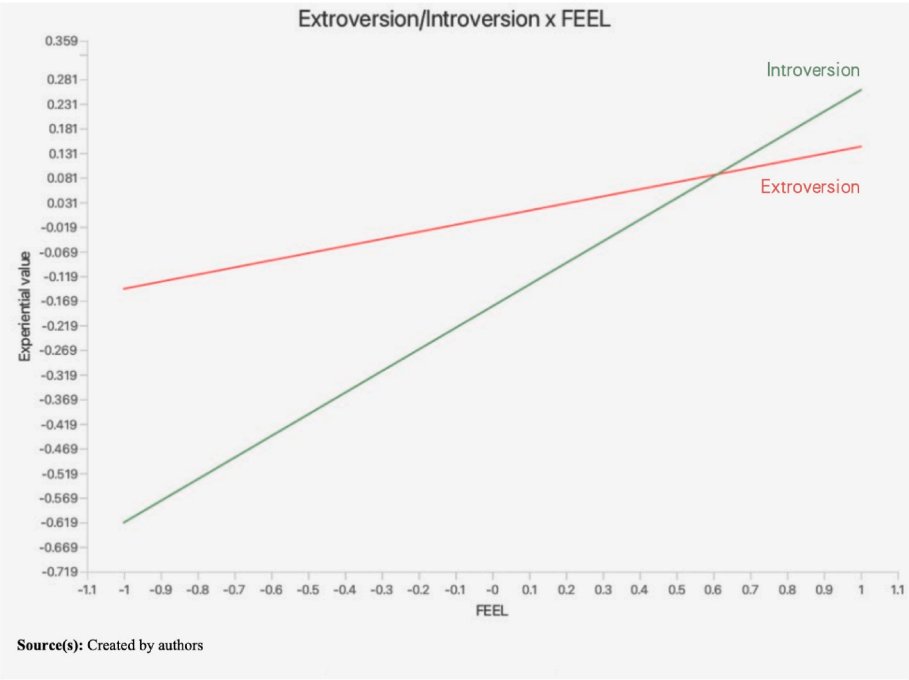


Fig. 3. Interaction diagram of personality between FEEL and Experiential value.

terms of experiential value and EV purchase intentions across the five dimensions. Previous research shows that introverts focus more on the emotional aspects of the EV experience (Chaturvedi et al., 2023; Dennis et al., 2022). We found that introverts place greater emphasis on the feel dimension, suggesting a preference for deeper emotional engagement. In contrast, extroverts are more influenced by the interactive and behavioral aspects of the EV experience—the sense, act, and relate dimensions—aligning with their tendency to seek active participation and social approval (Dinesh & Mitra, 2023; Mai & Olsen, 2015). Therefore, a quiet, immersive driving environment that fosters emotional connection may be more appealing to introverts, while opportunities for social interaction and self-expression may be more appealing to extroverts. These insights could guide companies in refining their marketing strategies to better address diverse consumer preferences and drive innovation in product development.

In the context of experiential marketing theory, we hypothesized that introversion and extroversion would significantly moderate the effect of the think dimension on experiential value. Surprisingly, the results showed that this moderating effect was nonsignificant, and the difference in the moderating effect between introversion and

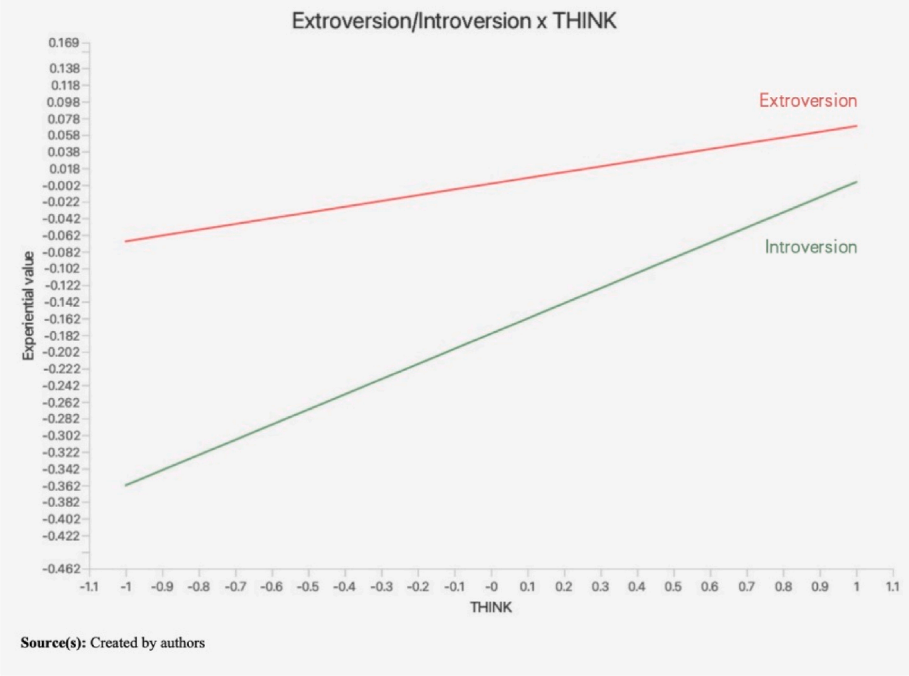


Fig. 4. Interaction diagram of personality between THINK and Experiential value.

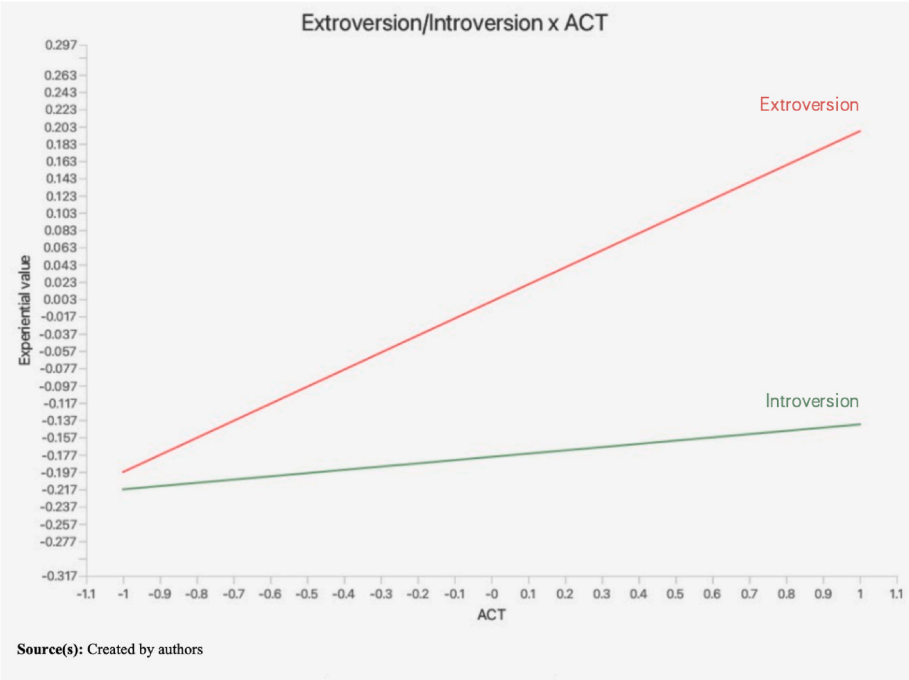


Fig. 5. Interaction diagram of personality between ACT and Experiential value.

extroversion was also nonsignificant. This may be attributable to several factors. First, introverts tend to think independently and process information more deeply and usually prefer complex and in-depth cognitive stimuli (M. W. Eysenck & Eysenck, 1979). However, in practice, the think dimension of experiential marketing may focus more on surface-level cognition rather than deep reflection, thus may fail to fulfill introverts' needs for deep thinking. In addition, introverts are more susceptible to cognitive load. When the think dimension is presented with an overload of superficial information, introverts may experience fatigue from cognitive overload (Kumari et al., 2004). Extroverts may also suffer from the disruptive effects of multidimensional experiences. In actual marketing situations, the think dimension is often intertwined with other dimensions (e.g., relate and sense), which may interfere with the cognitive motivations of both introverts and extroverts (Humphreys & Revelle, 1984). While extroverts are interested in new technologies and challenges, it may be difficult to boost their perceived experiential value if the experience is limited to logical reasoning and rational analysis and fails to incorporate interaction and sensory stimulation. Thus, the moderating effect of extroversion on the think dimensions is also somewhat limited. Therefore, the

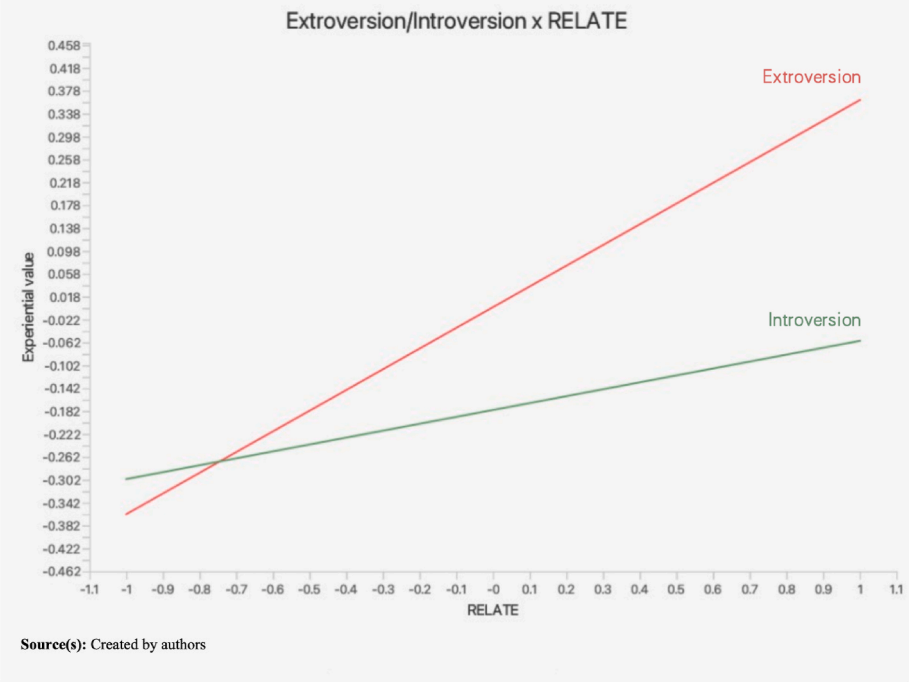


Fig. 6. Interaction diagram of personality between RELATE and Experiential value.

mixed effects of multidimensional experiences may lead to a nonsignificant moderating effect of extroversion on the relationship between the think dimension and experiential value.

6.1. *Theoretical implications*

The findings of this study help to fill the gaps in the current research, which has traditionally focused on the technical and functional features of products but has overlooked the potential of experiential marketing to convey deeper environmental values (Adu-Gyamfi et al., 2024; Huang & Ge, 2019). This element is crucial for adapting to an increasingly eco-conscious market (Laukkanen et al., 2022; Weber et al., 2021). By integrating green concepts within an experiential marketing framework, this study enriches the theoretical understanding of the concept and demonstrates how these elements can work synergistically to enhance product competitiveness and contribute to broader environmental goals.

This study makes a significant contribution to the literature on consumer segmentation and experiential marketing in the context of EVs. The incorporation of personality traits such as introversion and extroversion into segmentation models allows for a more accurate representation of the diversity of consumers and improves the precision of marketing messages (Hamburger et al., 2022; Itani et al., 2020; Moshkovitz & Hayat, 2021). This approach remedies the limitations of demographic-based segmentation, which, although useful for initial guidance, fails to capture the complex motivations underlying individual consumer behaviors (Huang & Ge, 2019). Additionally, this study responds to the need for a more in-depth psychoanalytic approach that transcends homogeneous demographic indicators, aiming for a deeper understanding of consumer behavior (H. J. Eysenck, 1990; Lu & Hsiao, 2010).

Further, previous research has tended to focus on a single dimension of experiential marketing. This study contributes to the literature by integrating all five dimensions of experiential marketing—sense, feel, think, act, and relate—into a comprehensive model of green purchase intentions (Amin & Tarun, 2021; Joshi et al., 2021; Laukkanen et al., 2022; X. Zhang, Chen, & Li, 2024). Moreover, prior studies on the influence of personality traits on pro-environmental behavior have yielded mixed results (Hirsh, 2014; Milfont & Sibley, 2012). This study addresses these inconsistencies by examining the role of personality traits in shaping consumer responses to marketing stimuli (H. J. Eysenck, 1990; Itani et al., 2020; Lu & Hsiao, 2010). It demonstrates the dual positive effect of experiential marketing on both general and green purchase intentions, aligning with sustainability goals and sustaining consumer engagement. Moreover, although introversion and extroversion are widely recognized as significantly influencing consumers' think dimension experience, our research indicates that superficial cognitive stimuli and multidimensional interference within the think dimension diminish the moderating influence of extroversion/introversion in actual marketing contexts.

This study expands on the prior research based on S-O-R theory (Luo et al., 2011; Prasad et al., 2022; Shen et al., 2024) by integrating ANT and SDL to establish a more holistic framework. This framework effectively addresses the intricacies, interactivity, and value cocreation dynamics inherent in experiential marketing, thereby enhancing adaptability in managing the interactions between both human and nonhuman elements. ANT places nonhuman elements (e.g., technology, product features, brand culture) on an equal footing with human factors, giving it greater explanatory power in dealing with complex experiential marketing environments (Centeno & Wang, 2017; da Silveira et al., 2022). The value cocreation logic of SDL explains the deep interactions between consumers and experiential marketing dimensions (Hollebeek, Srivastava, & Chen, 2019; Rasool et al., 2023). In contrast, the S-O-R model tends to describe static, unidirectional linear causality and explore external stimuli and human responses separately, ignoring the complex interactions between humans and value cocreation systems. ANT is more suitable for describing the mutual relationships between multiple factors in consumer decision-making. SDL posits that the exchange of services is not a unidirectional transfer but a process of cocreation (Rasool et al., 2023), thus is more applicable to explain the relationship between experiential value, consumer personality traits, and green purchase intentions. Additionally, the concept of experiential value departs from S-O-R theory by proposing that a consumer's personality, context, and other factors can alter their interpretation of the experience and value assignment (Hollebeek, Sprott, et al., 2019; Rasool et al., 2023). This is crucial for comprehending the ways in which both experiential marketing and personality traits influence consumers'

purchase intentions.

6.2. Managerial and policy implications

With respect to the practical implications of the findings, companies should develop targeted experiential marketing campaigns that comprise sensory, emotional, and cognitive experiences while promoting environmental values to meet the needs of increasingly eco-conscious consumers. Adopting these strategies will not only help firms build deeper connections with consumers but also foster long-term customer loyalty and a competitive advantage (Malek & Desai, 2022).

EV companies could also use personality profiling tools to segment their customers for tailored marketing campaigns (Lissitsa & Kol, 2021). This would enable companies to create marketing narratives and experiences that match specific personality traits and resonate better with consumers (Hollebeek, Sprott, et al., 2019; Tran et al., 2020). Personality-driven insights would not only prevent misdirection of resources but also foster consumer engagement and market growth (Shanahan et al., 2019). This research offers valuable guidance for EV companies. By integrating environmental values into the five dimensions of experiential marketing, companies can further improve their marketing strategies efficiently. This includes enhancing product appeal, maximizing resource utilization, and expanding market reach to become both competitive and responsible market players, while also boosting green purchase intentions (Amin & Tarun, 2021).

EV business strategists and marketing professionals could develop individualized marketing campaigns for introverts and extroverts to enhance consumers' perceived experiential value. Given that introverts and extroverts differ significantly in terms of their information processing, emotional responses, and decision-making (Jung, 1971), identifying these traits early will not only improve the accuracy of marketing campaigns but also enhance the customers' experience. These traits may be identified through marketing emails or online bookings for test drives by offering customers small gifts or discounts in return for completing a brief, validated personality questionnaire such as the Eysenck Personality Questionnaire or the Myers–Briggs Type Indicator (H. J. Eysenck, 1991). Because extroverts are more inclined to participate in group activities and live experiences, while introverts prefer independent research and detailed reading (Kim & Chock, 2017; Michikyan et al., 2014), it is also possible to use data mining and machine learning to automatically identify consumers' social media behaviors such as browsing frequency, number of clicks, and willingness to participate in offline activities (Nilashi et al., 2022; J. Wang & Liu, 2023). Marketers can then develop personalized marketing strategies based on consumers' personality traits to enhance experiential value for different personality types. For example, introverted consumers may prefer in-depth immersive experiences such as detailed virtual reality tours, in-depth information, and personalized consultations (C.-M. Chang et al., 2023), while extroverted consumers may prefer test drives activities and social gatherings to enhance their social experience (Viswanathan et al., 2018). Salespeople could draw on data analytics to adjust their communication style and service content based on the personality of the customer, thereby increasing the experiential value of the marketing campaign. For example, virtual reality experiences may attract technologically minded and introverted consumers (Lima & Hwang, 2024), while pop-up stores and test drives may cater to thrill-seeking and social extroverted consumers, increasing brand engagement and customer satisfaction (Syed-Yahya et al., 2025).

Building on these insights, we recommend that EV brands in China explore precision marketing strategies informed by consumer personality segmentation. Rather than adopting a one-size-fits-all approach, brands can tailor both digital and offline experiences to better align with the psychological preferences of different consumer segments. For example, brands focusing on family-oriented EV product lines, such as BYD and AITO, may benefit from organizing experience-driven events that encourage social interaction for more extroverted consumers, while also offering customizable digital tools or self-guided product exploration to accommodate introverted consumers who prefer more private, controlled environments. Similarly, brands known for their technological sophistication, such as Xiaomi, NIO, and Li Auto's lineup, might consider incorporating immersive virtual environments or interactive consultation features to appeal to consumers who score high in traits like openness or conscientiousness. As users' data collection becomes more refined, integrating AI-driven systems that personalize marketing content based on personality profiles could further enhance engagement across consumer touchpoints. Overall, personality-based precision marketing represents a promising approach for increasing customer resonance and achieving differentiation in China's highly competitive EV landscape.

It is particularly challenging for companies to improve experiential value by relying solely on superficial cognitive aspects of the think dimension. In the future, it may be beneficial for EV companies to consider developing more interactive and engaging cognitive experiences, such as gamified immersive experiences. For example, introverted users may appreciate an app game such as a battery technology decoding challenge that unlocks a "green engineer" medal. These games can be complemented by carbon-neutral micro-courses that are redeemable for personalized car purchase rewards. Extroverted consumers may enjoy activities such as zero-carbon test drive competitions or city landmark treasure hunts that enable them to win the title of environmental protection ambassador and receive community activity tickets.

From a policy perspective, the positive effects of the five experiential marketing dimensions on consumers' willingness to purchase EVs underscore the need to integrate these dimensions into the sustainability assessment framework. In addition, adding experience-based environmental education such as thematic courses or interactive activities to China's *New Energy Vehicle Development Plan 2035* could enhance consumer confidence in achieving the country's carbon emission reduction targets. Further, public facilities could be improved by establishing charging stations and green experiences in city parks. A green marketing certification system is also recommended in which subsidies or tax incentives are offered to brands adopting low-carbon technologies. To strengthen the evidence for new policies, big data and machine learning technologies could be used to simulate the effect of different experiential marketing strategies on transportation carbon emissions. This would help identify the incentive thresholds for various personality types and establish a system for exchanging carbon points for experiential rights and benefits, thereby providing a quantitative foundation for the National Climate Change Adaptation Strategy 2035 and the 14th Five-Year Plan for digital economy development in China.

6.3. Limitations and future directions

The findings of this study are limited to the Chinese market, which may not reflect consumer behavior in other cultural contexts. Given the study's sole focus on China and extroversion/introversion, other influential traits and factors may have been overlooked. Additionally, the rapidly evolving EV market and associated changes in policy, technology, and competition may affect the study's relevance. Future research should include diverse cultural and market environments to enhance the generalizability of findings. Examining a wider range of personality traits and their interactions with expertise and experience could provide a more comprehensive view of consumer behavior. The lack of a moderating effect of extroversion/introversion on the effect of the think dimension on experiential value necessitates further investigation into experience design to balance cognitive depth and interactivity, and better meet the needs of individuals with different personality traits. Additionally, incorporating multidimensional experiences to enhance the overall value of the interaction warrants consideration.

CRediT authorship contribution statement

Zhao Na: Writing – original draft, Methodology, Formal analysis, Data curation, Conceptualization. **Nik Mohd Hazrul Nik Hashim:** Writing – review & editing, Supervision, Conceptualization. **Nakaya Kakuda:** Writing – review & editing, Supervision, Investigation, Data curation, Conceptualization. **Shuyang Si:** Writing – review & editing, Funding acquisition.

Declaration of competing interest

The authors declare that there are no conflicts of interest regarding the publication of this manuscript. All authors have disclosed any potential financial or personal conflicts of interest that might be perceived as influencing the research and its outcomes.

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Data availability

Data will be made available on request.

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